**INSTRUCTIONAL AREA**
Customer Relations

# PRINCIPLES OF MARKETING

## PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

## SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

## CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

## PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Demonstrate a customer service mindset.
2. Handle customer/client complaints.
3. Interpret business policies to customers/clients.
4. Respond to customer inquiries.

**EVENT SITUATION**

You are to assume the role of a sales associate at TRAILHEAD OUTFITTERS, a store that sells hiking and camping gear. A customer (judge) is upset because the store will not accept the return of a pair of hiking boots.

TRAILHEAD OUTFITTERS allows customers to return new, unused items within 30 days with a receipt for a full refund. Items that have been used outdoors cannot be returned, but they can be exchanged if the product has a defect. The customer (judge) bought the hiking boots 45 days ago and has worn them on several hikes. The customer (judge) says the boots hurt his/her feet and wants a full refund.

The customer (judge) is a regular shopper at the store and is frustrated. You must explain the return policy to the customer (judge), respond to the complaint and find a solution that keeps the customer (judge) happy.

You will speak with the customer (judge) in a role-play to take place at the store's customer service counter. The customer (judge) will begin the role-play by explaining the problem. After you have handled the situation and have answered the customer's (judge's) questions, the customer (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your help.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Why does the store have a 30-day return policy anyway?
2. How can I avoid buying the wrong boots next time?

| Rate the participant's ability to: | | Novice | Developing | Proficient | Exemplary | Judged Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **PERFORMANCE INDICATORS** | | | | | | |
| 1. | Demonstrate a customer service mindset. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7 | 8-9-10-11 | 12 | |
| 2. | Handle customer/client complaints. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7 | 8-9-10-11 | 12 | |
| 3. | Interpret business policies to customers/clients. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7 | 8-9-10-11 | 12 | |
| 4. | Respond to customer inquiries. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7 | 8-9-10-11 | 12 | |
| **SOLUTION** | | | | | | |
| 4. | **Unique**<br>Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach. | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| 5. | **Practical**<br>Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context. | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| 6. | **Effective**<br>Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| **CAEREER COMPETANCIES** | | | | | | |
| 7. | **Critical Thinking**<br>Think critically to understand and solve problems | 0-1 | 2-3 | 4-5 | 6 | |
| 8. | **Communication**<br>Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason. | 0-1 | 2-3 | 4-5 | 6 | |
| 9. | **Decision Making**<br>Consider the impacts of decisions. | 0-1 | 2-3 | 4-5 | 6 | |
| **OVERALL IMPRESSIONS** | | | | | | |
| 10. | Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| | | | | | **TOTAL SCORE** | |